



Photo shows the style reference for the rattle, not the finished crocheted product.

LME CROCHET PATTERN - BABY

ELLIE'S RATTLE

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A little deer rattle on a wooden ring, approx. 13 to 15 cm tall. The head is shaped like a miniature version of Ellie, with soft ears, a bow, a ruffled collar around the neck and a rattle capsule safely tucked inside. Perfect for small hands to grip and shake.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the safety page once before you start. The rattle capsule must be sewn in completely and should never be removable by the child.

ABOUT ELLIE'S RATTLE

PART OF ELLIE'S WORLD

Ellie's rattle belongs to the LME Baby Collection "Woodland Dreams". This little deer head on a wooden ring is meant as the child's very first meeting with Ellie, made for hands that are still too small to hold the toy itself.

STYLE

Scandinavian and Montessori-inspired, in the same natural colours as the rest of the collection: brown, cream and sage green. A round, soft shape with no sharp edges.

FUNCTION

The wooden ring gives a safe, easy-to-grip handle shape. The rattle capsule inside the head makes a soft rustling sound. The soft ears give a little texture to explore with small fingers.

MATERIALS AND YARN ALTERNATIVES

YARN

Bystrikk Merino, brown (main colour) and cream (inside of the ears), the same yarn as the rest of the Ellie collection.

Alternative yarn: any soft cotton-blend DK-weight yarn works well, for example DROPS Safran or Hobbii Amigo. Cotton is easiest to wash clean and holds up best to regular hand washing.

TOOLS AND SUPPLIES

- **Heklenål 3 eller 3,5 mm** · litt tettere enn Ellie selv, siden hodet er lite
- **Polyesterfiber til fyll** · liten mengde
- **Trering, ca. 6 til 7 cm i diameter** · umalt, CE-merket, beregnet for barn
- **Rangleboks eller rangleinnsats** · en liten, lukket kapsel med rangleperler, beregnet for amigurumi/leketøy. Aldri løse perler eller bjeller direkte i fyllet
- **Stoppenål med butt spiss** · til all somming
- **Tvinnet bomullstråd og nål** · til å sy rangleboksen og ringen godt fast
- **Saks og målebånd**

DIFFICULTY, SIZE AND GAUGE

DIFFICULTY

Easy. A nice project if you have just learned amigurumi.

FINISHED HEIGHT

Approx. 13 to 15 cm, from the bottom of the wooden ring to the top of the ears.

GAUGE

Crochet tightly, amigurumi tension: approx. 20 sc x 22 rounds = 10 x 10 cm on a 3 mm hook. The stuffing and rattle capsule should not show through, or feel sharp through, the stitches.

ABBREVIATIONS (NORWEGIAN AND US)

Most of the rattle is crocheted with single crochet in a spiral, but the ruffled collar needs double crochet. Here are all the abbreviations, with the common US crochet terms alongside, plus the sewing technique used to sew the pieces on.

Norwegian	US	Means
lm	ch	luftmaske / chain
fm	sc	fastmaske / single crochet
stav	dc	stav / double crochet
kjm	sl st	kjedemaske / slip stitch
magisk ring	magic ring	justerbar startring uten hull i midten
økn	inc	økning: 2 fm i samme maske. Gir én maske mer.
mink	dec	minking: 2 fm sammen. Gir én maske mindre.
m	st(s)	maske(r)
omg	rnd	omgang, en hel runde rundt i spiral
()	()	totalt antall masker på omgangen
...	*...*	gjenta det mellom stjernene så mange ganger som står bak
heftesting	running stitch	sømteknikk (ikke hekling): tette, jevne sting rett gjennom begge lag med synål og tråd, brukes til å sy deler fast

TIPS BEFORE YOU START

- Buy the rattle capsule before you start, so you know it fits inside the head before you finish crocheting.
- Stuff filling around the rattle capsule on all sides, so it cannot slide and rattle loosely inside.
- Hold the ring up against the head as you go, to check the proportions look right.

HOW THE RATTLE IS BUILT

Four pieces are crocheted separately, then sewn together around the wooden ring at the end:

1. The head

holds the rattle capsule inside

2. The neck and collar

a tube with a ruffled edge, sewn around the wooden ring

3. The ears

two, soft, two layers

4. The bow

between the ears

SIZE

Approx. 13 to 15 cm, from the bottom of the wooden ring to the top of the ears.

PART 1: THE HEAD

The head is crocheted in a spiral, from the top down, in brown. The rattle capsule is inserted before the last rounds are closed.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30
6 to 9	30 sc, 4 rounds with no increases	30
10	(3 sc, dec) x 6 - stuff firmly from here	24
11	(2 sc, dec) x 6 - insert the rattle capsule now, well surrounded by stuffing	18
12	(1 sc, dec) x 6	12
13	dec x 6	6

Do not cut the yarn. Diameter approx. 8 cm. You use the same yarn to attach the head to the neck later.

PART 2: THE NECK AND THE WOODEN RING

The neck is a short tube that is sewn around the wooden ring and attaches the head to the handle.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3 to 5	12 sc, 3 rounds	12

Do not cut the yarn. Place the wooden ring inside the neck tube, fold the edge of the tube over the ring and sew all the way around it with tight, secure stitches, so the ring is fully enclosed and cannot slide out.

THE RUFFLED COLLAR (POWDER PINK) - CROCHETED SEPARATELY

The collar is not crocheted directly onto the neck, it is a separate little piece sewn on afterwards. Chain 18, join into a ring with 1 slip stitch in the very first chain (make sure the chain is not twisted before you join). Round 1: *1 sc in the next stitch, skip 1 stitch, 3 dc in the next stitch (a little fan)*, repeat 6 times around the whole ring until you are back at the start (18 stitches total in the ring, 6 fans). Finish with a slip stitch in the very first sc, cut and leave a tail of approx. 15 cm.

PLACEMENT

Sew the collar in place with running stitch around the top edge of the neck tube, before you sew the head on top.

ATTACH THE HEAD TO THE NECK

Sew the head onto the neck with tight stitches all the way around, centred over the ring.

PART 3: THE EARS AND THE BOW

THE EARS (MAKE 2, TWO LAYERS)

Outside (brown): 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18). Fasten off. Inside (cream): 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12). Fasten off. Sew the light circle onto the middle of the brown one, and sew the ears onto the top of the head, one on each side.

THE BOW

Crochet a narrow strip in powder pink: chain 14 + 1 turning chain, sc in each stitch back across for 3 rows. Cut, leaving a long tail. Fold the strip together into a small bow shape and wrap a short length of yarn tightly around the centre a few times. Sew the bow on permanently and flat, between the ears.

THE FACE, EMBROIDERED

Embroider two round eyes in black satin stitch and a small black nose below. Finally, embroider 2 to 3 tiny cream dots (French knots or small dense satin-stitch dots) on the forehead, between the ears, just like the light spots on Ellie herself. No plastic safety eyes here, since the rattle must be entirely free of hard or loose parts apart from the rattle capsule, which is safely hidden inside.

ASSEMBLY, STEP BY STEP

- 1 Crochet the head, leave it open until the rattle capsule is ready.
- 2 Stuff the head evenly, place the rattle capsule in the middle, well surrounded by stuffing on all sides, and close the last rounds.
- 3 Crochet the neck, place the wooden ring inside, and sew the tube securely around the whole ring.
- 4 Finish crocheting the ruffled collar as its own piece, and sew it in place with running stitch around the top edge of the neck, before sewing the head on.
- 5 Sew the head onto the neck, centred over the ring and the collar.
- 6 Sew the ears onto the top of the head, and the bow between them.
- 7 Embroider the face.
- 8 Fasten every loose end securely on the inside, and trim what is left.
- 9 Gently shake the rattle and listen: the sound should come through evenly and clearly, with nothing rattling loose.

SAFETY

THE RATTLE CAPSULE MUST NEVER COME OUT

The rattle capsule is the only hard part in this rattle, and it must be fully enclosed by yarn and stuffing, with no opening. Check thoroughly that there are no gaps or weak seams it could fall out through, either when newly made or after washing and use over time.

MORE IMPORTANT RULES

- Always use under adult supervision, especially the first few times, until you are confident every seam holds.
- No parts are glued. Everything is sewn on with strong, twisted cotton thread and plenty of tight stitches.
- Use only a wooden ring and rattle capsule that are unpainted/CE-marked and intended for children, never reused parts from adult products.
- Check the rattle regularly for wear: loose threads, soft or uneven patches, or a rattle capsule that feels loose. Discard the rattle immediately if anything is wrong.
- This pattern is a guide for home use. If the finished product is sold, it must always be checked, tested and marked as required under current local safety requirements and regulations for children's products/toys.

CARE AND WASHING

Hand wash in lukewarm water with a little mild soap. Rinse well. Gently press out the water in a towel, do not wring. Lay flat to dry, and check that the rattle capsule has not taken on water before using the rattle again.

CONGRATULATIONS, THE RATTLE IS DONE!

Now you have crocheted a little Ellie rattle. Give it a gentle shake and listen to the soft sound!

THE REST OF THE LME BABY COLLECTION

- Ellie, the little fawn
- Ellie's pacifier clip
- Ellie's activity toy
- Ellie's stroller toy
- Ellie's ballerina shoes with a bow

COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished pieces you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · lmexplorers.com